

Hwange Diocesan Sacramental Database System

Comprehensive Operations Manual (Heavy Duty Edition)

Version 3.1 • Diocesan Gold Standard

Table of Contents

- [Introduction & Vision](#)
- [System Architecture & Requirements](#)
- [Authentication & Access Control](#)
- [Parishioner Management \(The Faithful Registry\)](#)
- [The Sacramental Hub \(Canonical Modules\)](#)
- [Clergy & Mission Management](#)
- [Communication Hub & Support Tickets](#)
- [The Canonical Handshake \(Handover Protocol\)](#)
- [Reporting & Data Analytics](#)
- [Advanced Troubleshooting & System Health](#)

1. Introduction & Vision

The Hwange Diocesan Records Management System (RMS) is a custom-built digital ecosystem designed to unify the sacramental life of the Roman Catholic Diocese of Hwange. Its primary goal is to ensure the **integrity, availability, and confidentiality** of the canonical records of the faithful, from Baptism to the Order of Christian Funerals.

2. System Architecture & Requirements

Technology Stack

- Backend:** PHP 8.x with SQLite 3 high-performance database.
- Frontend:** Vanilla HTML5/CSS3 with a "Glassmorphism" design system.
- Deployment:** Portable local server environment (Zero-config).

Local Environment Setup

To ensure the system runs at peak performance:

- LAUNCH_RMS.bat:** The main entry point. Double-click this to start the PHP server.
- SYSTEM_HEALTH_CHECK.bat:** Run this if the dashboard feels sluggish. It clears temporary caches and verifies database integrity.

3. Authentication & Access Control

The system uses a **Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)** model to protect sensitive data.

User Roles

Role	Permissions
Administrator	Full system access, user management, and global data correction.
Parish Priest	Access to mission-specific faithful, sacramental entry, and handover tools.
Bishop / Chancery	Diocesan oversight, analytics, and final approval of mission transitions.

Password Security

Passwords are encrypted using the `PASSWORD_ARGON2ID` algorithm. If you forget your password, the **Forgot Password** portal uses time-limited reset tokens sent to your registered diocesan email.

4. Parishioner Management (The Faithful Registry)

The **Faithful Registry** is the backbone of the system. Every sacrament must be linked to a valid person in this registry.

Search & Filtering

The system uses an **Intelligent Search Engine** that scans:

- Legal First and Last Names.
- Baptismal/Other Names.
- Parish of Registry.

Status Indicators

- [ACTIVE]: Currently registered in the local mission.
- [MIGRANT]: Transferred out to another mission (Canonical move).
- [IMMIGRANT]: Transferred into the mission (Pending records update).
- [DECEASED]: Final rest (Locked for sacramental changes).

5. The Sacramental Hub (Canonical Modules)

Each module is governed by the Code of Canon Law (CIC 1983).

5.1 Baptismal Registry (Canon 849)

- Fields:** Name, Parents, Godparents, Minister, Date, and Location.
- Note:** All other sacraments (Confirmation, Marriage) are cross-referenced to the Baptismal record for validity.

5.2 First Holy Communion (Canon 897)

- Registry of the faithful who have reached the age of reason and received the Eucharist.

5.3 Confirmation Registry (Canon 879)

- Fields:** Sponsor, Minister (usually the Bishop), and Confirmation Name.

5.4 Matrimonial Registry (Canon 1055)

- Fields:** Groom, Bride, Witnesses, Dispensations (if any), and Presiding Minister.
- Certificates:** One-click generation of the Official Matrimonial Certificate.

5.5 Death & Burial Registry (Canon 1176)

- Records the final rites and ecclesiastical funeral of the faithful.

6. Clergy & Mission Management

The **Clergy Command Center** allows the Chancery to manage the movement of priests within the Diocese.

- **Deanery Oversight:** Parishes are grouped by Deanery (e.g., Hwange, Binga, Victoria Falls).
- **Mission Transitions:** Tracking the formal assignment dates of priests.

7. Communication Hub & Support Tickets

To replace fragmented WhatsApp/Email communication, the **Communication Hub** provides a centralized platform.

- **Categories:** Registry Correction, Dispensation Request, Canonical Query, Technical Support.
- **Priority Levels:** Low, Medium, High, URGENT.
- **Tracking:** View the full history of communication between the Parish and the Chancery.

8. The Canonical Handshake (Handover Protocol)

When a priest moves missions, the system enforces a strict "Handshake":

1. **Outgoing Priest:** Submits a "Handover Report" summarizing the current state of the parish registry and physical books.
2. **Incoming Priest:** Reviews the digital report and accepts the data.
3. **Audit:** The Chancery receives a notification when the handshake is complete, finalizing the transfer of digital access.

9. Reporting & Data Analytics

The **Oversight Portal** (Bishop's View) provides data-driven pastoral insights:

- **Growth Trends:** See which missions are seeing more Baptisms.
- **Vocation Monitor:** Track seminarians and aspirants across the Diocese.
- **Statistical Returns:** Automated generation of the annual status animarum report.

10. Advanced Troubleshooting & System Health

Database Backups

Run `BACKUP_DATABASE.bat` every Friday. This creates a timestamped copy of `database.sqlite` in the `/backups` directory.

Common Error Resolutions

- **"Database Locked":** Usually caused by another script accessing the file. Run `SYSTEM_HEALTH_CHECK.bat` to clear locks.
- **"Session Expired":** For security, sessions last 30 minutes. Refresh the page to log back in.
- **"Blank Page":** Check that the PHP server is actually running in the terminal window.